

Braking system that is held off by a partial vacuum and applied when air is let into the system. This was earlier used in the place of air brakes.

VALVE

Found in steam locomotives, valves coordinate the movement of steam in and out of cylinders. In diesel engines, valves control the fuel intake and expulsion of exhaust gases.

VALVE GEAR

Linkages that connect valves of a steam locomotive and keep in control movement of the valves.

VIADUCT

A long bridge supported by a series of arches. It carries a road or railway across a valley or low-lying land.

WAGON

Type of a rail vehicle that carries freight.

WHEEL ARRANGEMENT

A method of classifying locomotives by the distribution of different types of wheels. For steam locomotives, the Whyte notation is a common system according to which the leading wheels, driving wheels, and trailing wheels, are denoted by a numeral each. Diesel and electric locomotives and powered cars are categorized by the number of powered and unpowered axles they have.

WHEELSET

Assembly that consists of two wheels attached to an axle on a rail vehicle.

YARD

A separate area with multiple tracks and sidings (a short railway track beside the main tracks) for storage, maintenance, and loading and